



MODUS OPERANDI*

- Selecting unguarded targets to obtain maximum results.
- Targeting places of worship to disturb communal harmony.
- Targeting public transport and markets, cinema halls and tourist spots to create panic.
- Extensive use of commercial and home-made explosives in addition to RDX and TNT.
- Fabricating, designing and planting IEDs with less explosive but more shrapnel to maximise impact.
- Use of highly sophisticated triggering mechanisms, hybrid remote control switching systems, cell-phones as triggers and micro-controller based programmable timers for desired time delay.

*Source: National Bomb Data Centre, NSG.

to deny any role in terror attacks.

before being killed by unidentified gunmen there in 2008. "The names may change, but this is a long-term project. It goes on uninterrupted," says a senior intelligence official.

"There are only two ways to shut down this project," says an intelligence official. "Either we neutralise them ourselves (using covert options) or Pakistan hands over the accused like the Bhatkal brothers and Rasool and stop terrorism." With neither option visible on the horizon, the Home Ministry is going back to asking for Headley in the hope of preventing further strikes. Following the Pune blast, Home Minister P. Chidambaram said India had once again sought access to Headley. Though details of his interrogation were shared with India, Home Ministry sources said that access to him may have prevented Pune.

Even in this worrisome tale of hunting for the enemies among us, however, there is a slight ray of hope. Indians have so far been used by the ISI only for the kind of "insidious attacks" as Chidambaram called it, leaving behind an explosive-laden bag in public places. No Indian has so far been used to carry out fidayeen attacks like the one in Mumbai, which calls for a level of indoctrination and brutality that has so far been seen only in Pakistani jihadi recruits. "But who knows what the future holds?" asks a senior intelligence official.

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